

Dermatology Service Line Handbook

Meridian Health Partners
Department of Dermatology
Service Line Handbook V1.1
Effective Date: 2024-03-15

1.0 Scope of Service

1.1. The Meridian Health Partners (MHP) Department of Dermatology provides comprehensive outpatient dermatological care across its 14 clinical sites.

1.2. Accepted Conditions for Consultation and Management:

1.2.1. Acne vulgaris and related disorders.

1.2.2. Eczema (atopic dermatitis, contact dermatitis, dyshidrotic eczema).

1.2.3. Psoriasis and other papulosquamous disorders.

1.2.4. Rosacea.

1.2.5. Skin cancer screening, including mole mapping and evaluation of suspicious lesions.

1.2.6. Management of actinic keratoses via cryotherapy, topical agents, or other in-office procedures.

1.2.7. Benign lesion removal deemed medically necessary (e.g., symptomatic seborrheic keratoses, painful lipomas, skin tags causing recurrent irritation or bleeding).

1.2.8. Fungal infections of the skin, hair, and nails (tinea, onychomycosis).

1.2.9. Hair loss (alopecia), including evaluation and initial management.

1.2.10. Common viral skin infections (e.g., warts, molluscum contagiosum).

1.2.11. Urticaria (hives) and angioedema.

1.3. Conditions Explicitly Not Accepted for Direct Management within MHP Dermatology:

1.3.1. Extensive burns requiring inpatient care or advanced wound management facilities beyond outpatient scope. Patients will be referred to the nearest Level I Trauma Center.

1.3.2. Complex reconstructive dermatologic surgery requiring general anesthesia or operating room facilities not present at MHP sites.

1.3.3. Severe autoimmune bullous diseases (e.g., pemphigus, severe bullous pemphigoid) requiring multidisciplinary tertiary care intervention. Patients with these conditions will be referred to specialist academic centers affiliated with Meridian Health Partners.

1.3.4. Pediatric dermatology cases for infants under 6 months requiring specialized inpatient management or complex diagnostic workup not available at MHP. These cases are referred to Meridian Children's Hospital.

1.3.5. Purely cosmetic procedures without medical indication (e.g., elective wrinkle reduction, non-symptomatic benign lesion removal solely for aesthetic reasons, unless specifically covered by supplemental benefit plans as outlined in Section 4.3).

2.0 Appointment Duration

2.1. The standard duration for a new patient consultation is 30 minutes.

2.2. The standard duration for a follow-up appointment or routine annual skin check is 15 minutes.

2.3. Appointments involving minor in-office procedures (e.g., single biopsy, cryotherapy, simple excisions of up to two lesions) are typically scheduled for 20-45 minutes, dependent on procedure complexity and number of lesions.

3.0 Patient Preparation Instructions

3.1. Patients are issued the following instructions prior to their Dermatology appointment:

3.1.1. Avoid applying makeup, lotion, sunscreen, deodorant, or any topical creams to the area of concern or the entire body on the day of the appointment. This ensures clear visualization of skin lesions and prevents interference with diagnostic tools.

3.1.2. For full-body skin examinations, patients should wear loose-fitting clothing that is easy to remove and put back on.

3.1.3. Patients must bring a comprehensive list of all current medications, including over-the-counter drugs, supplements, and any previous dermatological treatments (e.g., prescription creams, oral medications).

3.1.4. Patients should be prepared to discuss their complete medical history, including any previous skin conditions, surgeries, and family history of skin cancer.

3.1.5. For suspected fungal infections of the skin or nails, patients should shower the morning of the appointment but refrain from applying any powders, creams, or antifungal treatments to the affected area for at least 24 hours prior.

3.1.6. Patients should avoid artificial tanning (tanning beds) for at least 72 hours prior to a full-body skin check to ensure accurate assessment of skin lesions and pigmentation patterns.

4.0 Meridian Health Plans Coverage for Dermatology Services

4.1. Meridian Health Partners offers four primary health plans: Meridian Core, Meridian Plus, Meridian Choice, and Meridian Elite.

4.2. Covered Procedures and Plan Specifics:

4.2.1. Routine Skin Cancer Screening (Full Body Examination): Covered by Meridian Core, Meridian Plus, Meridian Choice, and Meridian Elite.

4.2.2. Biopsy of Suspected Malignant Lesions: Covered by Meridian Core, Meridian Plus, Meridian Choice, and Meridian Elite.

4.2.3. Cryotherapy for Actinic Keratoses: Covered by Meridian Core, Meridian Plus, Meridian Choice, and Meridian Elite.

4.2.4. Excisional Removal of Malignant Skin Lesions (e.g., Basal Cell Carcinoma, Squamous Cell Carcinoma, Melanoma): Covered by Meridian Core, Meridian Plus, Meridian Choice, and Meridian Elite.

4.2.5. Excisional Removal of Medically Necessary Benign Lesions (e.g., symptomatic cysts, lipomas, severely irritated skin tags): Covered by Meridian Plus, Meridian Choice, and Meridian Elite. Requires prior authorization for Meridian Plus. Not covered by Meridian Core.

4.2.6. Phototherapy (NB-UVB, PUVA) for Psoriasis or Eczema: Covered by Meridian Choice and Meridian Elite. Requires prior authorization for Meridian Choice. Not covered by Meridian Core or Meridian Plus.

4.2.7. Cosmetic Lesion Removal (e.g., non-symptomatic benign nevi, seborrheic keratoses solely for aesthetic reasons): Not covered by Meridian Core, Meridian Plus, or Meridian Choice. Limited coverage may be available under Meridian Elite Supplemental Benefits Schedule MHP-ELITE-C-003, Section 4.2.1 for specific cases of disfigurement or psychological distress, subject to medical director review and pre-approval by Dr. Anya Sharma.

5.0 Referral Turnaround Commitment

5.1. The MHP Department of Dermatology commits to the following processing times for incoming referrals from MHP primary care providers or external specialists:

5.1.1. Routine Referrals: Patient contact for scheduling will be initiated within 3 business days of receipt

of a complete referral packet.

5.1.2. Urgent Referrals (e.g., rapidly growing suspicious lesion, severe widespread rash impacting vital functions): Patient contact for scheduling will be initiated within 24 business hours of receipt of a complete and appropriately triaged urgent referral packet.

5.1.3. All referrals are reviewed by a board-certified dermatologist, Dr. Anya Sharma (Clinical Lead, Dermatology), or a designated delegate, prior to scheduling.